

Sathyabama's RISE: Building a Stronger Future

Sathyabama Institute of Science and Technology stands out as a beacon of educational excellence and social responsibility. Under the visionary leadership of Chancellor Dr. Mariazeena Johnson, this institution is redefining what it means to be a premier university in India, transforming lives through both world-class education and impactful community initiatives.

Chancellor Dr. Mariazeena Johnson clearly knows what her institution needs to be. As she puts it, "Where Education meets Excellence – that is a place to learn and a place to grow." This vision is embodied in Sathyabama's mission to shape the future through innovation, inclusivity, and empowerment.

Founded in 1987 by Dr. Jeppiaar, Sathyabama University has grown into one of India's top academic and research universities. Recognized for its rigorous academic programs across diverse fields such as engineering, law, pharmacy, architecture, and the arts, Sathyabama University offers 53 undergraduate and 28 postgraduate programs. In recent years, the university has garnered prestigious recognitions, including being consistently ranked among the top 100 institutions in India for eight consecutive years by the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) and an "A++" accreditation from the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC).

This journey of consistent improvement is largely due to the visionary leadership of Dr. Johnson and her team of faculty, who bring innovative pedagogical practices and cutting-edge research facilities to students. For instance, the Sathyabama Centre for Advanced Studies, a hub of academic and research excellence, houses advanced facilities such as an AI laboratory with supercomputing capabilities, a Centre of Excellence in Additive Manufacturing, a drone lab, and a media center. These facilities provide students with hands-on experience and foster a culture of exploration and innovation.

Under Dr. Johnson's leadership, Sathyabama University has pursued partnerships and collaborations that broaden students' horizons and enhance the institution's research capabilities. With more than 250 international Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) in place, Sathyabama offers opportunities for student and faculty exchanges, internships, and collaborative research projects with leading universities and industries worldwide. These partnerships ensure that students are well-prepared for



Dr. Mariazeena Johnson
Chancellor, Sathyabama Institute of Science and Technology

the global workforce. "Our collaborations are more than just alliances; they are pathways to prepare students for the global stage," Dr. Johnson explains.

One of Dr. Johnson's key goals is to make Sathyabama an inclusive institution that extends opportunities to the underprivileged and marginalized. Her dedication to social reform and women's empowerment has shaped the campus into a nurturing and equitable space. "True progress begins when we uplift those who are often overlooked," Dr. Johnson shares.

Her commitment is evident in initiatives like the "ANBU SHE FIRST" program, launched in 2024. Through this initiative, women receive health cards for free health check-ups, with an expected 1,000 beneficiaries each year. Dr. Johnson has also established scholarships through the Anbu Foundation, ensuring that deserving students have access to higher education, regardless of their socioeconomic backgrounds. Each year, nearly 1,400 students benefit from these scholarships, a testament to her unwavering dedication to social upliftment.

In collaboration with the Indian government, Dr. Johnson established the "Sathyabama Agri Innovation Hub" in 2022, specifically aimed at empowering tribal women of Jawadhu Hills. The campaign is named RISE, this initiative focuses on skills development in millet processing, beekeeping, honey processing, and digital marketing, providing these women with sustainable livelihood options. Rajammal, a participant from Peenjamandhai, shared how the program has introduced her to new cultivation techniques, boosting her income and confidence. Another beneficiary, Vennila from Jarthankollai, expressed, "Through millet processing and beekeeping, I have been able to earn a sustainable income and feel empowered like never before." Dr. Johnson's commitment to economic independence for tribal women exemplifies how Sathyabama's impact reaches beyond the classroom to transform lives in rural communities.

Dr. Johnson's vision for a better future is also rooted in her commitment to environmental sustainability. She is an ardent advocate for a greener India and has been instrumental in championing eco-friendly practices